

Complete Storybook + Next.js + Vercel Deployment Guide

A comprehensive guide for new developers to deploy Storybook component library with Next.js on Vercel platform.

Prerequisites

Before starting, make sure you have:

- **Node.js** version 18 or higher installed on your computer
- **Next.js project** already created and working
- **Vercel account** (free account is sufficient)
- Basic understanding of terminal/command line usage

💡 Tip: If you don't have a Next.js project yet, create one first using `npx create-next-app@latest my-project`

Part 1: Installation Process

Step 1: Install Storybook in Your Next.js Project

Open your terminal and navigate to your Next.js project folder, then run:

```
npm create storybook@latest  
#or  
yarn create storybook
```

What this command does:

- Automatically detects that you're using Next.js
- Installs all necessary Storybook dependencies

- Creates `.storybook` folder with configuration files
- Adds example stories to get you started
- Updates your `package.json` with Storybook scripts

Step 2: Handle Installation Issues (If Any)

If you encounter any errors during installation, run this upgrade command:

```
npx storybook@next upgrade  
#or  
yarn dlx storybook@next upgrade
```

When to use this:

- If you see dependency version conflicts
- If the installation process fails midway
- If you're upgrading from an older Storybook version

Step 3: Verify Installation

Check if installation was successful by running:

```
npm run storybook  
#or  
yarn storybook
```

This should open Storybook in your browser at `http://localhost:6006`

Part 2: Configuration Setup

Understanding the Configuration

The configuration ensures that Storybook works properly with your Next.js project's styling system.

Step 1: Configure Tailwind CSS Integration

In your project, locate or create the PostCSS configuration file. Add this configuration:

```
const config = {  
  "@tailwindcss/postcss": {},  
};
```

What this configuration does:

- Enables Tailwind CSS processing in Storybook
- Ensures your components look the same in Storybook as in your Next.js app
- Prevents styling conflicts between the two environments

Step 2: Verify CSS Integration

After configuration:

1. Restart your Storybook server (`npm run storybook`)
2. Check that your components display with correct Tailwind styling
3. Test a few different components to ensure consistency

Part 3: Deployment Process

Understanding Vercel Deployment

Vercel needs specific settings to build and serve your Storybook correctly, separate from your main Next.js application.

Step 1: Access Vercel Project Settings

1. **Log into Vercel:** Go to vercel.com and sign in
2. **Find Your Project:** Locate your Next.js project in the dashboard
3. **Open Settings:** Click on your project, then go to "Settings" tab
4. **Navigate to Build Settings:** Look for "Build & Output Settings" section

Step 2: Configure Build Settings

Make these specific changes in your Vercel settings:

Framework Preset

- **Change from:** "Next.js"
- **Change to:** "Other" (from the dropdown menu)

Why this change is important:

- Next.js preset tries to build your app, not Storybook
- "Other" preset gives you manual control over build commands
- Allows Vercel to focus on building Storybook static files

Build Command

- **Set to:** `npm run build-storybook` or `yarn build-storybook`

What this command does:

- Runs Storybook's build process
- Creates static HTML/CSS/JS files
- Optimizes files for production deployment

Output Directory

- **Set to:** `storybook-static`

Why this directory:

- This is where Storybook puts its built files
- Vercel needs to know where to find the files to serve
- Must match exactly (case-sensitive)

Step 3: Deploy Your Storybook

1. **Save Settings:** Click "Save" after making all changes
2. **Trigger Deployment:** Go to "Deployments" tab and click "Redeploy"
3. **Monitor Build:** Watch the build logs to ensure everything works correctly

4. **Test Deployment:** Visit your deployed URL to verify Storybook is working

Common Issues and Solutions

Issue 1: Build Fails with "Command not found"

Problem: Vercel can't find the `build-storybook` command **Solution:**

- Check that Storybook is properly installed
- Verify `package.json` has the `build-storybook` script
- Try reinstalling Storybook if needed

Issue 2: Styling Doesn't Work in Deployed Version

Problem: Components look different than in development **Solution:**

- Double-check the PostCSS configuration
- Ensure all CSS files are properly imported
- Verify Tailwind CSS is configured in both Next.js and Storybook

Issue 3: "Output Directory Not Found" Error

Problem: Vercel can't find the `storybook-static` folder **Solution:**

- Ensure the output directory is spelled exactly as `storybook-static`
- Check that the build command completed successfully
- Look at build logs for any build failures

Issue 4: Components Not Loading

Problem: Storybook builds but components don't display **Solution:**

- Check that your stories are in the correct location
 - Verify component imports in your stories
 - Ensure all dependencies are properly installed
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Quick Reference Commands

```
# Install Storybook
npm create storybook@latest
# or
yarn create storybook

# Fix installation issues
npx storybook@next upgrade
# or
yarn dlx storybook@next upgrade

# Run Storybook locally
npm run storybook
#or
yarn storybook

# Build for production
npm run build-storybook
# or
yarn build-storybook
```

Quick Reference Settings

Vercel Build Settings:

- Framework: "Other"
- Build Command: `npm run build-storybook` or `yarn build-storybook`
- Output Directory: `storybook-static`